

Green & Social Claims Risk Assessment - Methodology

This document explains how the hosted scan screens company websites, related company domains and claim-related documents for greenwashing and social-washing risk signals. It is intended as a professional triage methodology for communications, legal, compliance and sustainability teams.

1. Purpose and scope

- The scan is not a broad ESG rating. It focuses on public green and social claims: whether they are specific, substantiated, audience-appropriate and consistent with public-source context.
- The scan separates green claim signals from social claim signals and provides three scores: global, green and social.
- The assessment is a first-pass risk signal. It is not legal advice, not a legal judgement and not a definitive finding of greenwashing or social washing.

2. Communication-channel logic

Channel	How the scan treats it
Client-facing websites / commercial documents	Homepages, product pages, campaign pages, folders, brochures and other communications likely to be seen by customers or consumers. Green claims in this channel receive the strongest EmpCo relevance and higher wording/substantiation scrutiny.
Investor or internal documents	Annual reports, sustainability reports, ESG reports, policies, supplier codes and governance documents are primarily treated as substantiation, governance and consistency evidence. They are not treated as consumer advertising unless the same wording is reused in client-facing communication.
External public-source signals	Only sources external to the company are displayed in the external signals section: regulators, courts, authorities, NGOs, media and other third-party sources. Company-owned reports, policies and supplier documents are excluded from this section, although they may support evidence review.

3. Regulatory and standards lenses

- Green claims are assessed through an EmpCo / Directive (EU) 2024/825 lens, especially for B2C commercial communications. The scan looks for generic environmental claims, climate-neutrality or offsetting claims, circularity/recyclability claims, sustainability labels, comparative environmental claims and future environmental-performance claims.
- Social claims are assessed through a social-washing methodology covering labour, human rights, workers, suppliers, diversity, customer welfare and community claims. Product, supplier, import/export, traceability, modern-slavery and forced-labour claims receive an additional Regulation (EU) 2024/3015 Forced Labour Regulation lens.
- Clear risk signals under EmpCo or the Forced Labour Regulation receive higher weight than broader responsible-business claims mainly linked to OECD Guidelines, UN Global Compact or UN Guiding Principles expectations.

4. Score calculation

Driver	Weight	Meaning
Claim wording risk	30%	Higher where claims are broad, generic, absolute, comparative, prominent or directly linked to EmpCo or Forced Labour Regulation topics.
Substantiation / evidence gap	30%	Higher where the scanned sources lack scope, methodology, KPI/data, verification, limits, grievance/remedy, supplier traceability, product risk assessment or remediation evidence.
External contradictory context	25%	Higher where external public sources indicate regulatory, legal, NGO, media or other third-party signals in the same claim area. Company-owned documents are excluded from this driver display.
Sector risk / exposure	15%	Baseline sensitivity factor. Some sectors are structurally more exposed to green or social washing allegations, but sector exposure alone cannot create a High-risk result.

5. External-source filtering

- The scan attempts to remove company-owned domains, corporate report PDFs, own policies, supplier codes, human-rights statements, sustainability reports and annual reports from the external-source display.
- External-source examples that can be retained include regulator notices, court/litigation materials, NGO reports, union statements, media investigations and third-party watchdog or civil-society publications.
- External sources are review signals only. Each source should be manually verified for relevance, date, jurisdiction, company identity and connection to the specific claim.

6. Sector exposure

- Higher exposure sectors include apparel/fast fashion, discount retail, food retail, commodities, high-emission sectors, chemicals, energy, aviation, logistics, agriculture-linked supply chains and sectors with outsourced or vulnerable workforces.
- Sector exposure influences baseline sensitivity and recommended controls. It does not replace evidence-based claim review.

7. Outputs

- The web output separates green claim signals and social claim signals, explains the company-specific score drivers, identifies red flags and provides recommended actions.
- The 2-page PDF report is designed as a concise management/client-ready summary. The claim-register CSV supports operational follow-up, ownership and evidence tracking.

8. Limitations and disclaimer

The scan is an indicative first-pass assessment. It does not provide legal advice, does not establish a violation of EmpCo, Regulation (EU) 2024/3015 or any other legal framework, and does not make a definitive greenwashing or social-washing finding. Results should be reviewed by legal, compliance and subject-matter experts before being used externally.